

"Cyberbullying is the use of digital communication technologies, such as social media, instant messaging, or gaming sites, to repeatedly harass, humiliate, or threaten another person." Unlike any other form of bullying, cyberbullying is sustained because, in this case, the audience is huge, and the material is permanent.

The Process (Step-by-Step) In a typical scenario, such as the widely documented **2013 Rebecca Sedwick case**, the process follows a predatory pattern:

1. **Isolation:** The target is excluded from group chats or digital "circles."
2. **Public Shaming:** Perpetrators post derogatory comments or edited photos across multiple platforms (Instagram, Ask.fm).
3. **Impersonation:** Bullies may create fake profiles to post offensive content in the victim's name, damaging their reputation.
4. **Dogpiling:** Encouraged by anonymity, others join in, creating a relentless stream of notifications that the victim cannot escape, even at home.

The targets usually include people perceived as "different" on the basis of physical appearance, academic or social status. For example, in Rebecca's case, she was bullied because of a misunderstanding involving a boy, with more than 15 girls cyberbullying her.

The consequences of cyberbullying have been devastating. For the victim, cyberbullying usually results in extreme anxiety, depression, and in some tragic cases, suicide. For the bully, the consequences include expulsion from school and possibly prosecution for cyberstalking. This is still a landmark case that shows how "words" in cyber space have fatal transformations into reality.

Source: *The New York Times*, "After a Suicide, Two Girls are Charged with Bullying," 2013.